
title: "Opening Range Breakout (ORB) Course ? Beginner Guide"

subtitle: "Accessibility-first v1 manuscript"

author: "ORB Collection"

date: "2026-05-17"

Front Matter

This manuscript consolidates the core ORB learning path into one document for consistent PDF export.

Audience:

- ? New traders
- ? Traders who prefer short, clear language
- ? Traders building disciplined checklist habits

Learning order:

- ? ORB Basics
- ? Timeframe Playbooks
- ? Risk and Trade Management
- ? Daily Checklist and Journal

1) ORB Basics

What is ORB?

ORB means Opening Range Breakout.

It uses the high and low of the first part of the market day.
If price breaks above the range, that is a possible long setup.
If price breaks below the range, that is a possible short setup.

Core idea

- ? Mark the opening range high and low.
- ? Wait for breakout direction.
- ? Confirm with volume and price behavior.
- ? Enter with a stop loss.
- ? Exit using a target plan.

Basic setup definitions

Setup	What you look for

Long ORB	Price breaks above range high and holds
Short ORB	Price breaks below range low and holds
False breakout	Price breaks out, then quickly fails back inside range

Long and short entry rules (simple)

Long entry

- ? Price closes above opening range high.
- ? Breakout bar volume is at or above recent average.
- ? Optional safer entry: wait for retest of range high and bounce.

Short entry

- ? Price closes below opening range low.
- ? Breakout bar volume is at or above recent average.
- ? Optional safer entry: wait for retest of range low and rejection.

2) Timeframe Playbooks

Quick comparison

Timeframe	Opening range window	Typical use	Notes
5m	09:30-09:35	Fast entries	More noise, faster decisions
15m	09:30-09:45	Beginner-friendly base model	Balanced speed and quality
30m	09:30-10:00	Higher confirmation	Fewer but often cleaner setups
60m	09:30-10:30	IB-style context trades	Slowest, most selective

Learning path by timeframe

- ? Learn 15m first for 2+ weeks.
- ? Add 30m to improve patience and filtering.
- ? Add 5m only after you can follow rules without emotion.
- ? Add 60m for context and selective high-quality setups.

Playbook format

- ? Mark OR high and OR low when the window closes.
- ? Wait for a breakout close.
- ? Check breakout volume.
- ? Enter on close or on retest.
- ? Place stop loss at the opposite side of setup structure.
- ? Take profit using fixed R targets (1R, 2R, etc.).

Per-timeframe notes

- ? 5m: fast, noisy, strict stops.
- ? 15m: default beginner model.
- ? 30m: cleaner structure, fewer trades.
- ? 60m: context-driven, selective.

3) Risk and Trade Management

Stop loss

Your stop loss is the price that proves your trade idea is wrong.

Long example

- ? OR high = 42,100
- ? Long entry = 42,108
- ? Stop below breakout/retest structure = 42,094
- ? Risk = 14 points

Short example

- ? OR low = 41,980
- ? Short entry = 41,972
- ? Stop above breakout/retest structure = 41,986
- ? Risk = 14 points

Take profit and R:R examples

Target type	Formula (long example)	Result if risk = 14 points
--- --- ---		
1R	Entry + 1 × risk	42,122
2R	Entry + 2 × risk	42,136
3R	Entry + 3 × risk	42,150

Tip: beginners can scale out at 1R and hold a smaller runner for 2R+.

Position sizing basics

- ? Pick max dollar risk per trade.
- ? Find stop distance in points.
- ? Convert points to dollar risk per contract.
- ? Contracts = max dollar risk ÷ risk per contract.

If result is not a whole number, round down.

False breakout response

- ? Exit quickly if invalidation is hit.

- ? Do not widen stop loss.
- ? Wait for a new valid setup.

4) Daily Checklist, Journal, and Paper Trading

Daily ORB checklist

Pre-market

- ? I know which ORB timeframe I am trading today (5m, 15m, 30m, or 60m).
- ? I marked key levels from prior session.
- ? I checked today's major news/events.
- ? I set max daily loss and max trades.
- ? I committed to no rule-breaking.

At setup

- ? Opening range is clearly marked.
- ? Breakout close is confirmed.
- ? Volume is acceptable.
- ? Stop and target are defined before entry.
- ? Position size follows risk limit.

Post-trade

- ? I recorded entry, stop, target, and result.
- ? I recorded whether I followed rules.
- ? I wrote one improvement for next trade/day.

Journal template

'markdown

ORB Journal - YYYY-MM-DD

Plan

- ? Timeframe used:
- ? Max risk per trade:
- ? Max daily loss:
- ? Session goal:

Trade Log

#	Time	Direction	Timeframe	Entry	Stop	Target(s)	Result (R)	Rules Followed?
1		Long/Short					Yes/No	
2		Long/Short					Yes/No	

Review

? Best trade:
? Worst mistake:
? One fix for tomorrow:
,

Appendix A ? Fast Glossary

Validated against:

? /home/runner/work/ORBZ/ORBZ/docs/glossary.md
? /home/runner/work/ORBZ/ORBZ/rules/observation-log.md

Term	Simple meaning
ORB	Opening Range Breakout
ORBH / ORBL	Opening Range High / Low
IB / IBH / IBL	Initial Balance and its high/low
VWAP	Volume-Weighted Average Price
Breakout	Price moves outside the opening range
Retest	Price returns to test a broken level
Rejection	Price tags a level and reverses quickly
Acceptance	Price holds beyond a level
Stop loss	Your exit if the idea is wrong
Target	Your planned profit level
R:R	Risk compared to possible reward
Two-Step Reversal	Failed IBH/IBL plus VWAP loss/reclaim regime shift

Appendix B ? Daily Checklist (Print-Friendly)

? Timeframe selected (5m/15m/30m/60m)
? Opening range marked
? Breakout close confirmed
? Volume check complete
? Stop and target planned
? Position size within risk limit
? Trade logged
? Rule-following reviewed